



Along the tracks

Steam locomotives were known as “iron horses” when they started a transportation revolution in the early 1800s, speeding up the movement of people and goods all over the world. Today, diesel and electric locomotives have taken over from steam.

1913

Grand Central Terminal opens in New York. The station has the most number of tracks—67 in all.

1829

The first modern steam locomotive, the *Rocket*, built by Robert Stephenson, sets new speed records.

1830 The first intercity steam passenger service, the Liverpool and Manchester Railway, begins.

1881

The first electric streetcar service begins in Germany.

1770

Scottish inventor James Watt invents the compound steam engine, versions of which will power early locomotives.

1869

The first Transcontinental Railroad across the USA is completed—a total of 1,907 miles (3,069 km) of tracks.

1800

1850

1900

1804

The *Pen-y-Darren* locomotive is built by British inventor Richard Trevithick, for work in mines.

1863

The first underground city railroad, the Metropolitan Line, opens in London.

1914

Throughout World War I, railroads prove invaluable for moving troops and supplies.

1906

The Simplon Tunnel, connecting Italy and Switzerland under the Alps, opens. It is the world's longest railroad tunnel.

Pen-y-Darren locomotive

